and glass connection to a nasal catheter. The large valve of the cylinder is opened with keys. There is a regulator to regulate the flow. See the figure below.



Key and Regulator



Oxygen cylinder

4.11.5 Care of oxygen cylinders:

1. Handle the cylinder with care.
2. Oxygen stand should be used to prevent falling and causing injury to someone or to the equipment.
3. It should be always placed at the head end of the bed.
4. Oxygen does not cause fire but it supports combustion.
5. Visitors and other patients may need to be reminded not to smoke. Hang "No smoking" board to the oxygen cylinder.
6. Oxygen cylinders should be stored in a cool temperature, because high temperature can cause expansion of the gas with consequent loss of gas through the safety valve.
7. Do not use electric appliances close to oxygen.
8. Oil or grease should not be used on the regulator, because in the presence of high oxygen concentration, oil is likely to catch the fire and the cylinder may explode.
9. Mark empty cylinder, replace protection cap, and set aside from full cylinders.
10. Inspect the apparatus at frequent intervals and make sure that it is in working condition. The nurse should learn the working of cylinders, its regulators etc. before handling the apparatus.

4.12.5 Precautions to be taken when using the oxygen cylinder:

1. Giving oxygen is an emergency procedure, so it should be ready for 24 hours.

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2. The nurse should see that the cylinders are full and all the apparatus is in working condition, the key is attached with the cylinder in a bag.
3. There should not be any leakage in the rubber tubings.
4. There should be written order for O_2 inhalation and specific dose must be prescribed to avoid oxygen toxicity.

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